CONSENT FORM

Widener University IRB Protocol Number: Leave blank. A number will be assigned.

Investigator Name: Lily Cohen, M.A.
Institute for Graduate Clinical Psychology
Widener University
Phone: 646-315-5233
Email: lecohen@widener.edu

Faculty Adviser: Dr. Linda Ruan, Ph.D.
Institute for Graduate Clinical Psychology
Widener University
Email: lruan1@widener.edu

Study Title: Lying in Children with ADHD: Impact on Parent–Child Relationship and Family Dynamics

PURPOSE OF THE STUDY

This research study is about how caregivers understand and respond to lying or honesty concerns in children with ADHD. It also looks at how these experiences may affect trust, communication, conflict, and family life.

I am being asked to be a participant in this study because I am an adult caregiver of a child who was diagnosed with ADHD between the ages of 6 and 13, and I have at least occasional concerns about the child's lying or honesty-related behaviors.
I can take part in this study if all of these are true:
- I am 18 years old or older.
- I am the child's primary caregiver (the adult mainly responsible for the child's day-to-day care).
- My child was between 6 and 13 years old when they were diagnosed with ADHD.
- My child has been diagnosed with ADHD by a qualified professional (for example, a pediatrician, psychologist, or psychiatrist).
- I have at least occasional concerns about my child's lying or honesty.
- I am comfortable completing a 20–40 minute interview in English by Zoom or telephone.

I cannot take part in this study if any of these are true:
- I am under 18 years old.
- I am not the child's primary caregiver.
- My child does not have an ADHD diagnosis from a qualified professional.
- My child is younger than 6 or older than 13.
- I have not had any concerns about my child's lying or honesty.
- I am not comfortable completing the interview in English.
- My child has another condition that strongly affects how they communicate or understand truth-telling (for example, a severe intellectual disability, a major neurological condition, psychosis, or autism with major communication difficulties).

DESCRIPTION OF THE STUDY

As a participant in this study, I will be asked to complete one interview by Zoom or telephone. Before the interview, I will answer a short set of background questions about me, my child, and my family. These questions ask about things like my background, my child's age, my child's ADHD history, our household, and my concerns about my child's lying or honesty.

During the interview, I will be asked about my experiences with my child's lying or honesty-related behaviors. I may be asked about what kinds of lying I notice, when it happens, how I understand it, how I respond, and how it affects trust, communication, conflict, and family life.

With my permission, the researcher will audio-record the interview so that it can be typed into a written transcript. The interview will not be video-recorded. I may still take part in the study if I do not want to answer a specific question.

This is a research study. It is not therapy, treatment, parenting advice, or an evaluation of me or my child.

Taking part is expected to take about 30 to 60 minutes total:
- Screening questions: about 3 to 5 minutes.
- Background questions: about 5 minutes.
- Interview: about 20 to 40 minutes.

There will be no cost to me related to study participation other than my own phone, internet, or data use.

RISKS AND DISCOMFORTS

In this study, I may feel some mild discomfort when talking about parenting stress, family conflict, my child's ADHD, or lying and honesty concerns. Some questions may feel personal, and I may feel upset, stressed, embarrassed, frustrated, or uncomfortable.

There is also a possible risk of loss of privacy. Because the interview will happen by Zoom or telephone, someone near me could overhear what I say. There is also a small risk that my information could be seen by someone who should not see it, especially while my information is being stored, moved, or typed into a transcript.

There are limits to confidentiality. If I share information that suggests possible child abuse or neglect, or a serious risk of harm to me or someone else, or another situation that the law requires the researcher to report, the researcher may have to report it to the proper authorities.

© Widener University

The risks that I might experience will be minimized in several ways. I may skip any question, take a break, or stop the interview at any time without penalty. The researcher will conduct the interview in a supportive and nonjudgmental manner. I will be encouraged to do the interview in a private place. I can use headphones so others are less likely to hear it. Before we start, I will be asked to confirm that I am in a place where I feel comfortable talking and where no one else can hear me. These steps will be the same whether I take part by Zoom or by telephone. I will also be encouraged to pick a time and place where my child cannot overhear the conversation.

The researcher will also take steps to protect my confidentiality. I will be assigned a study code, and identifying information will be removed from transcripts whenever possible. Recordings will be kept for a short time on a password-protected device or secure system. They will be deleted after the transcript is typed and checked. Study files will be stored on a password-protected, encrypted, university-approved system. Only approved research personnel will have access to the study data.

If I experience discomfort during the interview, I should tell the researcher. I may ask to pause, skip a question, take a break, reschedule, or stop participating. If I become upset, the researcher can share support resources with me, like the 988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline and local mental health resources. The researcher will not provide therapy, treatment, clinical advice, or emergency services as part of this study.

BENEFITS

There may be no direct benefits to participating in this study. Some people may find it helpful or meaningful to talk about their experiences.

What is learned may help researchers and clinicians who work with children with ADHD and their families. This study may help others better understand what caregivers go through with ADHD, lying, trust, communication, and family life. What is learned may help guide future caregiver support, clinical guidance, or family-based programs.

ALTERNATIVE PROCEDURES

The alternative to participating in this study is to not participate. There is no penalty for not participating in the study.

CONFIDENTIALITY

All documents and information pertaining to this research study will be kept confidential in accordance with all applicable federal, state, and local laws and regulations. I understand that data from the study may be reviewed by Widener University's Institutional Review Board, which is the committee responsible for ensuring my welfare and rights as a research participant, to assure proper conduct of the study and compliance with university regulations. If this research is presented or published, my name will not be used.

My study information will be kept for 3 years after the study ends. Then it will be deleted or destroyed. Audio recordings will be deleted after they are transcribed and checked for accuracy.

Data from the study will be stored on a password-protected, encrypted, university-approved system. Any signed consent forms or documents linking my name to my study code will be stored separately from de-identified study data. My name, phone number, and email address will be used only to schedule and complete the study. They will be kept separately from my answers and will be deleted once interviews and transcripts are finished. Signed consent forms will be kept for 3 years after the study ends and then destroyed.

© Widener University

My privacy and confidentiality will be protected in several ways. I will be given a study code. Names and identifying details will be removed from transcripts whenever possible. My identifying information will be kept apart from my study answers. Only approved research staff may see study files, and files are kept in password-protected, encrypted storage. A transcription service called Otter.ai will be used to help turn the recording into written words. The recording will go only to the researcher's password-protected Otter.ai account and will be deleted from that service once the written copy is downloaded and checked. The researcher will check the written copy for accuracy. The written transcript will have names and other identifying details removed.

TERMINATION OF PARTICIPATION

I may choose to withdraw from this study at any time and for any reason. If I choose to drop out of the study, I will contact the investigator. If I stop the interview, I can ask the researcher to delete audio recordings, notes, or other records that can still be linked to me. After names and identifying details are removed, it may not be possible to remove my specific statements later.

The researcher may end my participation in the study. This could happen if I do not meet the study requirements, if I cannot complete the interview, if I choose not to answer screening questions needed to confirm that I qualify, or if it would not be right to continue because of privacy, safety, or distress concerns. If the researcher ends my participation early, my information will be destroyed unless I say it can be kept and used.

COMPENSATION

If I complete the interview, I will be entered into a raffle for one of two $20 gift cards. Winners will be chosen at random after the study interviews are finished and will be contacted by email. Other than the raffle, I will not receive payment for being in this study. Participation in this study is strictly voluntary. There will be no cost to me for participating in this research other than my own phone, internet, or data use.

INJURY COMPENSATION

Neither Widener University nor any government or other agency funding this research project will provide special services, free care, or compensation for any injuries resulting from this research. I understand that treatment for such injuries will be at my expense and/or paid through my medical plan.

QUESTIONS

All of my questions have been answered to my satisfaction. If I have further questions about this study, I may contact:

Lily Cohen, M.A.
Phone: 646-315-5233
Email: lecohen@widener.edu

If I have any questions about the rights of research participants, I may call Widener University's Institutional Review Board at 610-499-4110 or email them at irb@widener.edu.

VOLUNTARY PARTICIPATION

I understand that my participation in this study is entirely voluntary, and that refusal to participate will involve no penalty or loss of benefits to me. I am free to withdraw or refuse consent, or to discontinue my participation

© Widener University

in this study at any time without penalty or consequence.

I voluntarily give my consent to participate in this research study. I understand that I will be given a copy of this consent form.

SIGNATURES

Participant's Name: _____.

Participant's Signature: _____ Date: _____.

I, the undersigned, certify that to the best of my knowledge, the participant signing this consent form has had the study fully and carefully explained by me and has been given an opportunity to ask any questions regarding the nature, risks, and benefits of participation in this research study.

Investigator's Name: Lily Cohen

Investigator's Signature: _____ Date: _____.

Widener University's IRB has approved the solicitation of participants for the study until: _____.

© Widener University